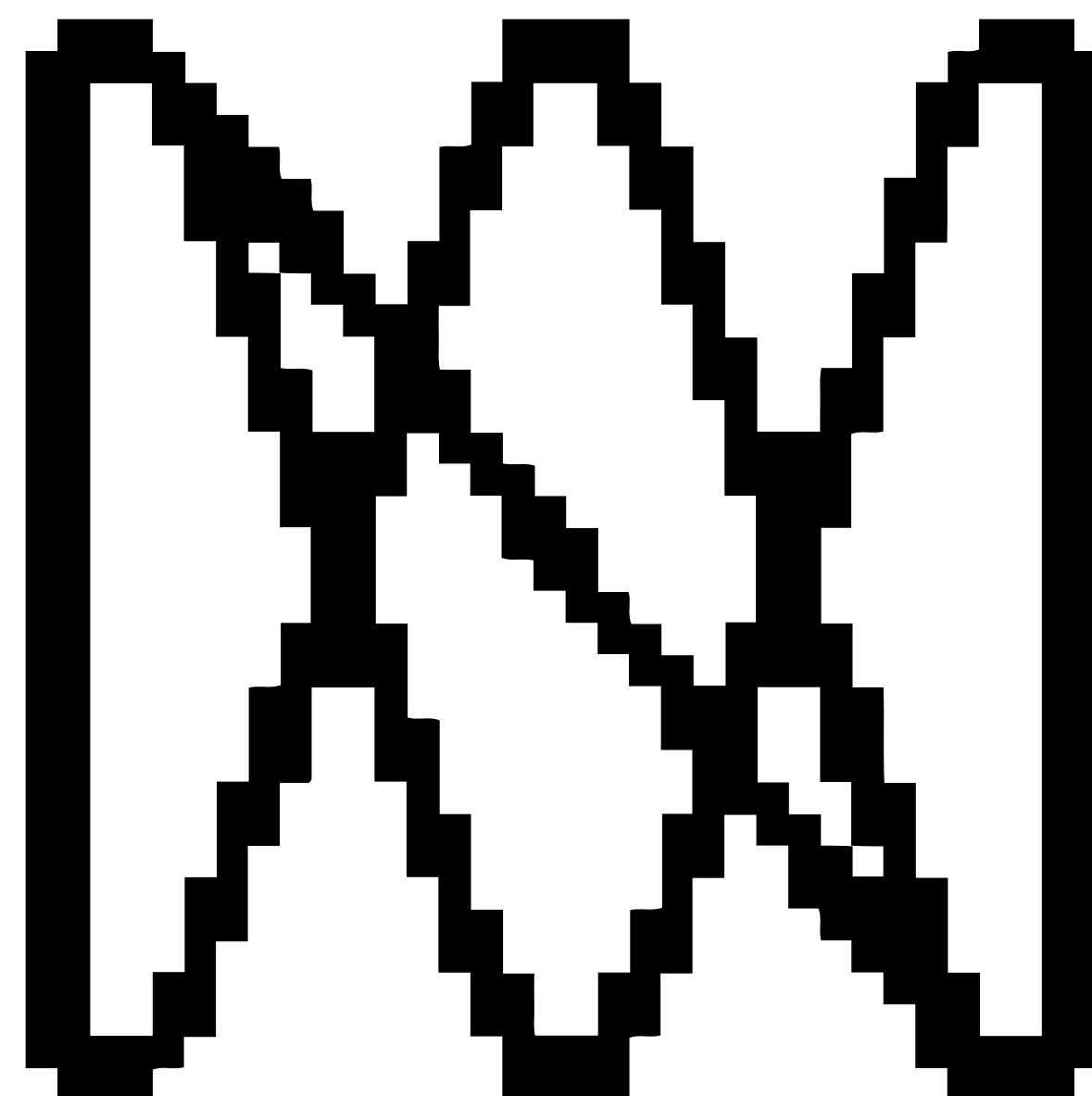




NAVA is an artist-led network for audiovisual artists across the Nordic, Baltic, and Arctic region. Through open calls, projects, and gatherings, NAVA connects music, visual art, and live experiences. The network supports interdisciplinary practices and encourages new collaborations across disciplines, borders, and cultures.

Nordic Audiovisual Artists (NAVA) was founded in 2016 by Jonas Johansson (SE), Rasmus Stride (DK/NO), Owen Hindley (UK) and Atli Bollason (IS) during a collective project at Harpa, Reykjavík. In 2017, NAVA gained recognition with projects like Light Organ and Tiny/Massive at Sónar, pairing musicians and visual artists via open calls. By 2018, Icelandic designer Katrín Hauksdóttir joined, and in 2019, NAVA expanded beyond Iceland, hosting the event Skaðablót and continuing work across the Nordic region. NAVA, now mostly led by Jonas, partnered with Merle Karp and the Aavistus festival in Helsinki. In 2021, artist Annie Tådne co-founded Nonagon in Sweden. The network grew with collaborations like Nordic Lights, and in 2023 Jonas, Annie, and Merle performed at Arctic Sounds in Greenland, connecting with local talent like Naleraq Eugenius. In 2024 Jonas and NAVA connected with Kokong in Åland and Baltic Analog Lab in Latvia. The network thrives on experience exchange, strengthening the community's ability to create exceptional audiovisual work. NAVA is currently engaged in the project DOME DREAMING and ÖTOPIA (Creative Europe).



Nonagon Festival



Aavistus Festival



Baltic Analog Lab



Kokong Festival

Through open calls, projects, residencies,
and cross-disciplinary collaborations,
these selected reference projects present
our approach to producing high-quality
cultural interventions.

Alexander Wallin (SE) · Allenheimer (IS) · Amalie Smed (DK)
Charlotte Risch (FR/JP) · Daniel Wirtberg (SE) · Freya Sif Hestnes (DK)
Good Moon Deer (IS) · Hackstage (DK) · Hekla (IS) · Hermigervill (IS)
Hilmar Gudjonsson (IS) · Ida Davidsson (SE) · Ilavenilj (IS) · Íris Þórarins (IS)
Jana Spacelight (DE) · Johanna Tano (SE) · Jonas Johansson (SE)
Jonatan van Hove (BE) · Juliette Louste (FR) · Kesson (IT) · Knogle (DK)
Kristin Wichstrøm (DK) · Lars Buchholtz (DK) · Lau Lindqvist (DK)
Line Finderjup Jensen (DK) · Mad Es (DK) · Mads Nilsen (DK) · Manual
Visuals (DK) · Melissa Follestad (NO) · Owen Hindley (UK) · Oscar
Gränse (SE) · Pete Fleming (UK) · Plútó (IS) · Rasmus Meilvang (DK)
Rasmus Stride (DK) · Samuli Alapuranen (FI) · Sasha Smirnova (BY)
Sofia-Lill Jansson (SE) · Sólveig Matthildur (IS) · Sort Stoj (DK)
Spherical Aberration (RO) · Studio Industries (NO) · Sune Petersen (DK)
Tirador (ES) · Van Ta (DE) · Videoapelsin (SE) and many more.

SÓNAR 2018

In 2018, NAVA partnered with Sónar Reykjavík to create a series of collaborative audiovisual performances inside Harpa Concert Hall. Through an open call, NAVA received 24 applications and selected four visual artists: Freya Sif Hestnes (DK), Sofia-lill Jansson (SE), Samuli Alapuranen (FI), and Daniel Wirtberg (SE). Each was paired with a musical act programmed at the festival, resulting in unique one-off performances that merged experimental sound and live visuals on stage.

Freya Sif Hestnes collaborated with IDA IDK, creating a vibrant live show that fused electronic pop music with Freya's shadow play. The other selected artists likewise brought their own sensibilities to the festival, expanding the dialogue between music and visual art in Reykjavík.

The project also marked NAVA's first official meetup, bringing together artists from across the Nordic region for exchange, workshops, and collective creation. Over several days, participants engaged in rehearsals, discussions, and performances, establishing the collaborative spirit that is central to NAVA's work.



ROSKILDE (2016–2019)

From 2016 to 2019, NAVA collaborated with Roskilde Festival to bring live audiovisual performances to the Countdown Stage, a platform dedicated to emerging musical acts leading up to the festival's main programme. Through an annual open call, artists were invited to perform live visuals (VJ) in collaboration with booked music acts.

The project paired musicians and visual artists, creating unique, one-off performances that fused sound and imagery in front of thousands of festival-goers. Each year, selected artists received an artist fee, festival pass, and the opportunity to present their work on one of Northern Europe's most iconic festival stages.

Highlights included performances by Spherical Aberration (RO), Kesson (IT), and Sasha Smirnova (BY), who illuminated the Danish skies with their expansive visual worlds. Across the years, NAVA curated and co-ordinated dozens of acts, ensuring a vibrant dialogue between music and visuals.

The Roskilde collaboration not only gave young audiovisual artists an international platform but also helped establish NAVA's working method of open calls, pairing, and co-creation – an approach that continues to shape the network's projects today.



SKAÐABLÓT (2019)

In April 2019, following the cancellation of Sónar Reykjavík, NAVA and Plútó co-hosted Skaðablót at Bíó Paradís in Reykjavík. A one-day festival dedicated to audiovisual performance, workshops, and screenings. The event marked NAVA's first independently organised festival and became a meeting point for artists across the Nordic and international scene.

From an open call that received 124 applications, three visual artists were selected: Tirador (ES), Van Ta (ES), and Jana Spacelight (DE). Each was paired with Icelandic musicians for unique one-off performances:

- Örvar Smáráson x Tirador
- Hermigervill x Van Ta
- Sólveig Matthildur x Jana Spacelight.

The night also featured performances by Bjarki x VIDEO1, Allenheimer, Good Moon Deer, Íris Þórarins & Joon, who presented ABZŪ live, and Everlasting Grace, a live motion capture performance by Owen Hindley, Jonas Johansson, Alexander Wallin and Juliette Louste.

The programme extended beyond live shows. Daytime activities included a Touch Designer GLSL Shader workshop, screenings of Smash TV's works Skinemax, Memorex and Megaplex, and the premiere of MUNSTUR – More & More & More & More directed by Anna Maggý. Skaðablót culminated in an afterparty at Gaukurinn with DJ sets from Kero Kero Bonito, Phil Hartnoll (Orbital), and Plútó DJs.

All proceeds supported an emergency fund for Icelandic electronic musicians, underlining the community-driven ethos of the event. Skaðablót not only showcased cutting-edge audiovisual practices but also reinforced Reykjavík as a hub for experimental art, collaboration, and resilience.



TINY/MASSIVE (2019)

Tiny/Massive transformed the Harpa concert hall in Reykjavík into an interactive, illuminated canvas, exploring the potential of large buildings with low-resolution LED façades. Artists were invited to create animations, interactive visualisers and arcade style games that animated Harpa's distinctive glass exterior, turning the structure into a dynamic interplay of light, motion, and participation.

A bus outside Harpa served as both a viewing space and an interactive hub, where audiences could manipulate the visuals and sound using arcade-style controllers. Over four nights, 58 works responded to the monumental scale and structural rhythm of the façade.

NAVA oversaw all aspects of the project, from curating an open call to developing a “creator's tool kit” that streamlined artistic integration within the constraints of the low-resolution display. Live musicians performed inside the bus, with Harpa's façade reacting dynamically to sound, deepening the dialogue between light, music, and architecture.

Tiny/Massive re-imagined urban façades as interactive spaces, merging public art, technology, and audience engagement. While realised at Harpa, the project reflected a broader inquiry into the creative possibilities of large-scale, low-resolution displays.



TOUR DE LUX (2020)

TOUR DE LUX was a rolling parade of projections, where bicycles were transformed into mobile audiovisual platforms. Each bike was equipped with a projector and battery, enabling urban screenings, pop-up performances, and improvisational stages that lit up the city after dark.

NAVA invited design teams in three cities to develop their own projection bikes: Carl Edwin Waerner (Stockholm), Rasmus Stride (Oslo), and Jan-Erik Lindroos (Helsinki). Together, they created a roaming festival on wheels, where public space became an open canvas for experimentation and collaboration.

The project not only demonstrated the creative potential of mobile, low-threshold audiovisual art but also planted seeds for new initiatives; In Helsinki, Jan-Erik Lindroos went on to found the Freaky Bike Parade, an annual large-scale event that has grown into a colourful, community-driven audiovisual “critical mass,” attracting hundreds of participants with sound system bikes, projection bikes, and decorated rides.

TOUR DE LUX showed how technology, performance, and cycling culture could merge into a playful, sustainable format. One that continues to roll forward in new forms across the Nordic region.



NORDIC LIGHTS (2020)

Nordic Lights was a collaborative project uniting three emerging audiovisual festivals—Aavistus in Helsinki, Nonagon in Sweden, and Monument in Norway. With 12 artists paired into 6 new acts through an open call, the project pushed cross-border artistic exploration, combining sound, visuals, and performance to create innovative, site-specific works.

A stand out collaboration at Monument was dance performance blending choreography with audio-visual elements, exploring movement and sound in a dynamic interplay. Meanwhile, at Nonagon, artists Rosanna Lorenzen and Zuzana Bottová fused acoustic sound with electronic manipulation to create a composition that transforms the space of an old factory, turning it into an auditory and visual landscape.

Nordic Lights emphasised the power of collaboration, encouraging artists to experiment with new forms and express cultural and environmental themes.



ARCTIC LIGHTS (2023)

The Arctic Lights project, supported by NAPA, the Nordic Culture Fund, and the Nordic Culture Point, took Jonas Johansson, Annie Tådne, and Merle Karp to Sisimiut, Greenland, where they collaborated with artists performing at the Arctic Sounds Music Festival. During their three-week residency, the team led workshops on audiovisual production, sparking creative exchanges with local and international artists.

The project also involved immersive experiences in the stunning natural environment of Greenland. They explored the surrounding nature through hikes, deeply engaging with the landscape that inspired their work. They had the unique opportunity to sing with the local choir, fostering a connection with the local community, and participated in meaningful exchanges with the festival's light designers and technicians, sharing knowledge on audiovisual practices.

Through Arctic Lights, Jonas, Annie, and Merle also formed lasting connections with artists from Denmark, Iceland, and Greenland, strengthening the Nordic artistic network. The project celebrated the power of collaboration, artistic growth, and the shared experience of creating art in such an inspiring and remote location.



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Logo by Jonas Johansson.